

LION KOZLINSKY

Location: Andorra / Citizenship: Latvia

Mobile: +376 390750

E-mail: ogionw@gmail.com

OBJECTIVE

Lead Backend Engineer / Team Lead (PHP, Symfony / Laravel) with extensive experience in scalable backend systems and distributed architectures, currently transitioning into AI-enabled backend engineering, including LLM-powered systems, RAG architectures, and business process automation. Open to fully remote roles with occasional on-site business travel.

ABOUT ME

Highly analytical Lead Software Engineer with 15 years of experience building distributed financial systems, payment integrations and high-load backend services with strong focus on system design.

I value transparency and constructive feedback, consistently follow through on commitments. Perform effectively in collaborative environments, actively share knowledge and focus on practical solutions over hierarchy or ego.

PROFESSIONAL STRENGTHS

- Strong self-management skills with the ability to lead and mentor engineering teams
- Proven ability to identify, prioritize, and deliver business value
- Extensive experience working directly with business stakeholders and translating requirements into technical solutions
- Strong understanding and application of software engineering best practices, resulting in clean and testable code
- Reliably delivering high-quality solutions under tight deadlines and pressure
- Deep experience in legacy system modernization and refactoring at scale
- Effective task prioritization focused on maximizing business impact within time constraints
- Strong team player with a collaborative and knowledge-sharing mindset
- High level of ownership and commitment to achieving shared team goals

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Team Lead at [First Prudential Markets](#)

Oct 2024 – April 2026

- Gathered business requirements for a standalone financial service responsible for inbound and outbound money transfers across 6 trading platforms, integrating 30+ service providers and supporting dynamically changing business rules.
- Assembled a high-performing engineering team of 7 employees to establish effective and transparent development processes
- Together with my team delivered a high-quality Payment Service, enabling efficient management by business stakeholders and eliminating payment related incidents across CYSEC
- Designed the service architecture and inter-service communication, and implemented 50% of the solution
- Led a full team assessment (15 employees), aligning team composition with business goals, addressing performance gaps and improving delivery.
- Organized and led 3 company-wide software architecture seminars (30+ participants) to improve code quality
- Oversaw releases and development processes and actively contributed through hands-on coding

Senior Backend Developer at [Aramis Censio](#)

Dec 2023 – Sep 2024

- Successfully completed the development of a web-based diamond sales analyzer for the government of Angola
- Successfully designed and implemented a diamond valuation software for Brussels based company

Senior Backend Developer at [Stickcredit](#)

Sep 2022 - Nov 2023

- Successfully developed fully functional credit software integrated with various third-party services and government institutions

Senior Backend Developer at OrangeSky/Sun Finance

Nov 2021 - Jul 2022

- Unified authorization for various financial systems within the Azure cloud service (with a small part unified within AWS for testing)
- Created and integrated universal modules for a network of financial systems

Backend Developer at Printify

Sep 2020 - Nov 2021

- As part of the supply team, connected approximately 20 print providers to our API, ensuring flawless order processing
- Automated a significant portion of manual work, reducing the overall time to connect a print provider by 80%

Engineering Manager at IET

Apr 2013 - Jul 2020

- Lead a team that has debugged and refactored a large amount of legacy code
- Designed a unique automated meta-testing framework, resulting in a 90% reduction in losses and a 30% increase in revenue
- Singlehandedly successfully maintained and upgraded a high-load affiliate platform
- Created an entry journal for the Latvian cargo port of Liepaja

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Architecture: OOP, Patterns, DDD, Legacy, EDD with Event Storming, Event Sourcing, CQRS, Clean Architecture, Microservices, SOA

Languages:

- **PHP:** Professional level, Experience with Yii, Laravel, Symfony, Zend2 frameworks. Preferred frameworks – Symfony, Laravel
- **Python:** intermediate level (Fast API)
- **Javascript / JQuery:** Secondary skill, used only for form manipulations.
- **Angular / Vue:** basic knowledge
- **HTML / CSS:** Basic+ level, can create simple webpages
- **C#:** basic+ level, a couple of websites created
- **C, C++:** basic+ level, a couple of applications over the years
- **Assembler, Java:** beginner level

Protocols and communication: REST API, Web Sockets, Redis, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Protobuf

Databases: Mysql (professional), MS-SQL, Postgres, MongoDB

OS: Windows: some programs written in WinAPI. Linux and Mac-OS (can grep the logs, write primitive bash scripts, apt-get install programs)

Cloud: AWS/Azure/GCP (user level), API Integration, Web sockets

IDE: MS Visual Studio, PhpStorm (Default), PyCharm, Cursor

Profiling: Blackfire (beginner level)

Testing: PHPUnit, PHPSpec, Codeception, Cypress (beginner level), Selenium (beginner level)

Version control: Git

Automatization: Claude code, Junie, Manus, Browser Use, Playwright

Additionally proficient with: Docker, Elasticsearch (via Kibana), Grafana, Prometheus, Jenkins, Apache/Nginx, MS Office, Miro, Jira, RabbitMQ/AMQP, Kafka, IBM Rational Roze

EDUCATION

- 2026 - Google AI Certification
- 2026 - Google IT Automation with Python Certification
- 2021 – Event Sourcing conference
- 2020 – DDD Europe 2020 conference
- 2011-2014 “IT Management” MSc at Transport and Telecommunication Institute, Riga
- 2006-2011 “Computer sciences” BSc at Transport and Telecommunication Institute, Riga